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Lab 4

Data Preparation

For the data preparation, I found my data set on Kaggle, seeing as though it had a 10 for usability. I knew that this was a good data set to use because it had a lot of different variables that I could work with. It was also a data set that I was interested in, so I thought it would be fun to work with. I did not have a hard time uploading this set to Tableau since it was extremely cleaned up on its own.

Design Choices

When picking a design for my visualization, I wanted to make it simple, so I went with a bar graph. I thought that this would be the best way to show the data that the set had provided. I decided to show the different ratings of each Netflix Movie and TV Show title that was available when this set was created. It separated the movies and TV shows between TV-MA, R, PG-13, and others.

Expected Patterns

When I first looked at the data, I expected to see a more even distribution of ratings across the different categories. I thought that the ratings would be fairly evenly spread out, with no single category dominating the others. After looking at the visualization, it was clear that this was not the case. I expected to see a majority of titles in the R category, as well as PG. It was really interesting to see the way it was organized after.

Surprises/Outliers

Looking through my metrics and dimensions, I knew that there were a lot of different ways I could organize them for my visualization. Since I ended up with the ratings, I was expecting to see a good spread between the different types of ratings. To my surprise TV-MA had the highest number of titles under that category. From what I knew about Netflix, I knew that they were trying to cater to different audiences, so I honestly expected to find a more even spread than what was presented. Although I was wrong with my prior understanding of the topic, it was interesting to see the difference between the different rating categories.

Questions for Further Investigation

Some questions that would help explain the outliers or surprises might be: Why is TV-MA the most common rating? What factors contribute to the distribution of ratings across different categories? Does Netflix intentionally not have equally rated movies to appeal to a certain audience?

Tool Evaluation

Tableau proved to be a powerful tool for creating visualizations, offering a beginner-friendly interface. It did a good job at allowing me to quickly create and modify the visualizations. I really enjoyed the use of the drag and drop option that Tableau gives you. It made it extremely easy to input the data into the software. Tableau also made it very simple to understand the data set I had selected even though the set had a wide range of variables. I did not encounter many significant issues while using Tableau, but I do believe that other softwares can do a better job at cleaning up data when needed, especially with strange outliers that shouldn't be there.